



Release Criteria Checklist - Open Government Canada

This form is a tool to ensure that an analysis of legal and policy requirements has been completed prior to the release of data to the public and internally. It also documents the approvals required for the release of the resource on open.canada.ca (Open Data, and Open Maps - OGP Open Government Portal available to the public) or Federal Geospatial Platform (FGP) only for spatial records, internal to GC.

Metadata/Resource Name	Description	Release Platform
Integrating Gut Microbiota and Population Genomics in White Hake (<i>Urophycis tenuis</i>): Supporting Data 83113cc4-43e8-11f1-ae0a-ff739810e62a	Integrating host-associated microbiota with genomic approaches offers an opportunity to better understand the multiple biological dimensions shaping population structure in marine fishes. A clear understanding of population structure and dynamics is essential for informed fisheries management and conservation decisions; however, while genomic approaches have greatly improved our ability to delineate biological populations, they provide only a partial representation of biological structure, as patterns of differentiation reflect both historical divergence and contemporary ecological conditions. Host-associated microbiota can influence population-level ecological processes by contributing functional, potentially heritable variation that shapes host phenotype and fitness. In this study, we combined genotyping-by-sequencing with 16S rRNA gene amplicon sequencing to examine how population genomic structure relates to gut microbiota composition and to evaluate whether microbiota community variation provides complementary insights into population structure in White Hake (<i>Urophycis tenuis</i>) in eastern Canada. Genomic analyses identified two populations with greater spatial overlap than previously reported. Variation partitioning revealed that host genetics explained a negligible proportion of microbiota variation compared to environmental factors and fish length, suggesting that ontogenetic shifts in habitat use and resource acquisition influence gut microbiota composition. Several taxa were differentially abundant among fish length categories used as a proxy for diet, including taxa with chitin-degrading potential such as <i>Photobacterium</i> and <i>Lachnospirales</i> , which were enriched in smaller fish known to consume a crustacean-dominated diet. Together, these results indicate that gut microbiota composition in White Hake primarily reflects ecological and life-history processes rather than host population structure.	OGP

Release Criteria Checklist - Mandatory that all answers are YES to publish!

Legal / Licensing / Copyright

1. There are no known legal, licensing, or copyright restrictions to prevent the data or information from being released by the department or agency under the terms of the [Open Government Licence - Canada](#).

Authority to Release

2. Does DFO/CCG have the departmental mandate, legislative authority or permission from a third party provider to publish the data or information resource under the [Open Government Licence - Canada](#).

Access to Information and Privacy

3. Has the data/information been reviewed to ensure it is not subject to any exemptions or exclusions under the [Access to Information Act](#)?

4. Has the data/information been reviewed to ensure it does not contain any personal or confidential information? For further ATIP or privacy related guidance, please refer to the [Guidelines for the Informal Release of Information](#).

Security

5. Has the data/information to be released been reviewed and determined to be unclassified?

Note: Protected A, B, confidential, secret data/information cannot be posted on the Open Government Portal.

For further guidance on security categories, please refer to the following documents: [Information Security Guide](#) and the [TBS Directive on Security Management - Appendix J: Standard on Security Categorization](#).

Cost

5. Is the data/information being released without a fee to the public?

Format

7. Is the data/information provided in machine-readable/machine processable format?

8. Is the data/information provided in an open and non-proprietary format?

For further guidance on open and non-proprietary format, please refer to the [Standard on Web Accessibility](#).

Metadata

9. Is the metadata for the data/information consistent with the Government of Canada metadata standard? For further guidance on metadata, please refer to the [TBS Standard on Metadata](#).

Official Languages

10. Are the metadata and data both being provided in English and French as per the [Official Languages Act](#)?

Associated Publications

Is this dataset associated with a publication? If yes, please provide details:

This dataset has no associated publications.

I, François-Étienne Sylvain, answer YES to all the above questions and hereby authorize the release of the above dataset and related metadata on the Government of Canada's [Open Government Portal](#), to be freely available under the terms and conditions of the [Open Government Licence - Canada](#).

Furthermore, I confirm that this dataset and any future updates, meet and will meet the mandatory Release Criteria Checklist outlined above.

NOTE: the remaining approvals must be completed in the Enterprise Data Hub.

Data Contributor:

Title:	François-Étienne Sylvain, Aquatic Science Biologist	Digitally approved by François-Étienne Sylvain on April 30, 2026, 3:57 p.m.
Sector:	Ecosystems & Oceans Science (Gulf)	

Data Steward:

Title:	Amélie Robichaud, Senior Program Officer / Administrateur de programme principal	Digitally approved by Amélie Robichaud on May 4, 2026, 2:09 p.m.
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Generated via DM Apps on May 4, 2026, 2:09 p.m.